

Kansas City Barbeque Society (KCBS)

Sanctioned Competition Registration · Hudson Valley BBQ Championship

Entry: KCBS-HV-2026-118
Sanctioned Event
Registered: 2026-06-20

Competition Team Registration

Team	Ladder and Smoke	Event	Hudson Valley BBQ Championship
Head cook	Chris Johnson	Location	Riverfront Park, Beacon, NY
Co-cook	Tommy Brennan	Date	November 29, 2026
KCBS member #	MB-448120	Format	KCBS 4-meat, blind judging

Categories & Turn-in Times

Category	Turn-in	Lead cook	Notes
Chicken	12:00 PM	Chris	Thighs
Pork ribs	12:30 PM	Tommy	St. Louis cut
Pork	1:00 PM	Tommy	Butt + burnt ends
Brisket	1:30 PM	Chris	Post oak, 14-hr Texas-style

Fees & Site

Item	Amount	Status
Team entry (sanctioned)	\$225.00	Paid
Electric hookup, 30 amp	\$45.00	Paid
Extra competitor wristbands (2)	\$30.00	Paid
People's Choice add-on	\$50.00	Paid
Total entry cost	\$350.00	

Budget Competition costs average about \$420 per event split 50/50 with Tommy. Meat, wood, and supplies are tracked separately in the team cost-split log and reconciled in the barbecue book at tax time. Best finish to date is 8th overall at this same championship.

Prior Season Results (Ladder and Smoke)

Event	Overall	Best category	Score
Beacon Spring Smoke	15th	Brisket 8th	167.4
Kingston Rib Fest	11th	Ribs 6th	171.2
Poughkeepsie Classic	10th	Chicken 7th	169.8
Hudson Valley Championship	8th	Brisket 4th	174.6

Logistics & Equipment

The competition rig (Weber Smokey Mountain 22-inch plus the custom offset trailer) tows behind the Tahoe. Load-in is the afternoon of the 28th with an overnight cook. Required equipment includes calibrated thermometers, food-safe gloves, and sanitizer per KCBS rules; a health-department inspection is conducted at check-in. The date must be checked against the FDNY tour rotation and the crowded November calendar.

KCBS Rules Summary

- Blind judging: entries are turned in in numbered boxes with no team markings.
- Six certified judges score each entry on appearance, taste, and tenderness on a 2 to 9 scale.
- Meat must be inspected raw at check-in and held at safe temperature until cooking.
- Turn-in windows are strict; boxes late by more than five minutes are disqualified.
- Garnish is limited to approved greens; sculpting and marking the box are prohibited.

Awards & Payout

Overall and per-category awards are presented after scores are tabulated. Top-ten category calls earn ribbons, and the overall grand and reserve champions receive trophies and a share of the purse. Points also count toward the regional team-of-the-year standings. Ladder and Smoke targets a top-five overall at this event, its strongest of the season, with brisket the anchor category.